ALLY WEALTH

Goodreads Profile Setup Checklist

DISCOVERY • AUTHOR RESOURCE LIBRARY

A practical checklist for creating and maintaining an accurate author presence, verifying book information and participating respectfully in reader communities.

GET SEEN. GROW YOUR INFLUENCE. BUILD YOUR LEGACY.

How to use this resource

This guide is designed as a practical working document. Read it in sequence or move to the section that addresses your immediate need. Use the prompts to record decisions, assign actions and identify questions that require further research.

A note on platform guidance

Retailer features, metadata options, community rules and promotional policies can change. Verify current requirements with the relevant platform before making changes or launching a campaign. This guide is educational and does not guarantee rankings, reviews, sales or other outcomes.

Your working principles

Be accurate. Put reader relevance before vanity metrics. Respect platform rules and community boundaries. Keep records of decisions. Measure what matters to your goals.

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Section 01

Goodreads and reader discovery

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about goodreads and reader discovery. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 02

Claiming or verifying profile

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about claiming or verifying profile. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 03

Author photo and bio

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about author photo and bio. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 04

Book data accuracy

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about book data accuracy. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 05

Edition matching

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about edition matching. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 06

Series linking

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about series linking. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 07

Bibliography review

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about bibliography review. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 08

Profile links

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about profile links. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 09

Reader-facing description

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about reader-facing description. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

- Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.
- Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.
- Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.
- Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.
- Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 10

Giveaway considerations

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about giveaway considerations. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 11

Community etiquette

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about community etiquette. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

- Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.
- Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.
- Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.
- Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.
- Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 12

Review independence

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about review independence. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 13

Avoid review manipulation

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about avoid review manipulation. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

- Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.
- Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.
- Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.
- Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.
- Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 14

Reader questions

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about reader questions. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 15

Events and updates

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about events and updates. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 16

Profile maintenance

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about profile maintenance. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 17

Book data corrections

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about book data corrections. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 18

Duplicate records

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about duplicate records. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 19

Track reader engagement

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about track reader engagement. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 20

Cross-platform consistency

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about cross-platform consistency. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 21

Privacy and boundaries

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about privacy and boundaries. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 22

Common profile issues

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about common profile issues. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 23

Monthly checklist

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about monthly checklist. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 24

Profile audit

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about profile audit. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Working worksheet

Use this page to turn the guide into an action plan. Keep the scope realistic and prioritise the work that most directly supports the reader experience.

Area	Your decision / notes
Current position	
Priority improvement	
Evidence to collect	
Action owner	
Target date	
How success will be reviewed	

Your next 30 days

Choose a small number of actions you can complete consistently. Avoid changing multiple variables at once when you need to understand what made a difference.

Week 1: Review and research

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Week 2: Make the priority improvements

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Week 3: Publish, test or implement

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Week 4: Review evidence and decide what comes next

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Further notes and questions